

You can prepare livestock for export if you are a licensed exporter and have an [approved arrangement \(AA\)](#) and [approved export program \(AEP\)](#) in place. You can also prepare livestock for export if you have a [small and infrequent \(S&I\) exemption](#) to these requirements.

You must export in line with your approvals and follow requirements outlined in our [regulatory framework](#).

We charge a fee for most steps of the exporting livestock process. This fee is time-based for some steps. See our [charging guidelines](#).

Use our [quick-find reference tables](#) to locate more departmental webpages, documents and information relevant to livestock exports.

Follow these steps to prepare your livestock consignment for export.

[Micor \(Live Animals\)](#) sets out the known importing country requirements. You must meet these requirements to export live animals from Australia.

Access Micor

[Apply for a login](#) to access Micor information related to exporting livestock.

You must check Micor and any import permit conditions prior to each consignment.

Importing countries may change their requirements without notice and may not inform us. It is your responsibility to check requirements directly with the relevant government authority of the importing country.

For multiple use import permits, you must manage the quota. You do not need to provide us with this information unless we request it.

Requirements not listed

Sometimes a country or livestock commodity is not listed on Micor. In this case, the importing country requirements are set out in the import permit. You must get a valid import permit from the relevant destination country authority.

Changes to requirements

If requirements change and these have been agreed to, we will update Micor. If you receive requirements that are different to Micor, please [contact us immediately](#).

Once these changes have been agreed, you must update your [AA](#) and [AEP](#) to address them.

Some countries require pre-export isolation or quarantine. Our requirements depend on method of transport. For:

- air consignments, we must approve the premises before the start of isolation. You must submit the NOI at least 10 business days before the start of isolation.
- sea consignments, check importing requirements. Otherwise, follow [Australian Standards for the Export of Livestock \(ASEL\)](#) requirements.

You must have an approved exporter supply chain assurance system (ESCAS) to export feeder or slaughter livestock. You must identify the [relevant ESCAS approval](#) on your NOI. This is not required for breeder livestock.

You must submit your Notice of Intention to export (NOI) in TRACE via the [Export Service](#). If you haven't already, you will need to create an account to use the service.

Get set up in the Export Service

Follow our step-by-step guide [TRACE onboarding to the Export Service](#).

After your account is set up, you need to [connect TRACE to the Export Service](#).

You must submit an NOI for each consignment.

You must submit your NOI the earlier of (and at least):

- 10 business days before quarantine or isolation begins, or
- 10 business days before the consignment is proposed to be exported.

This timeframe also applies to reactivation of NOIs that have been placed 'on hold' in TRACE.

In some cases, we can accept NOIs with less than 10 business days' notice. This will depend on the NOI details and our availability to service the consignment. Please contact us to discuss if you are in this situation.

Contingency plans

In accordance with [Australian Standards for the Export of Livestock \(ASEL\)](#), contingency plans must be prepared in writing for each livestock consignment.

For consignments by sea to the Middle East, a contingency plan must be provided to the department at the time of NOI submission, or when otherwise requested by the department. We may also make ad hoc requests for contingency plans for livestock consignments exported to the Middle East by air.

Learn more about these requirements in the contingency plans for livestock consignments to the Middle East policy:

Download

- [Contingency plans for livestock consignments to the Middle East \(PDF 190 KB\)](#)
- [Contingency plans for livestock consignments to the Middle East \(DOCX 240 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Alternative export arrangements under ASEL

In some cases, you can apply for alternative export arrangements under ASEL. These apply to a specific consignment only. You can apply when you submit your NOI.

Find out how to apply for [alternative export arrangements under ASEL](#).

We may approve alternative pen space as part of your AA for some markets. You must self-assess if your consignment is eligible as [per our alternative minimum pen space allocation policy](#).

Other exemptions

In some cases, you can [apply for exemptions](#) from other requirements. These may apply to a specific consignment only.

Accredited stockpersons and veterinarians

ASEL requires an accredited stockperson to accompany all livestock voyages. See [LiveCorp Accredited stockpersons](#) for more information.

We will inform you if a shipboard accredited veterinarian (AAV) must accompany the consignment. See [when we may require a shipboard AAV](#).

We assess each NOI and notify you in TRACE if we approve it.

We will contact you if we require further information or market specific documents. Examples include a heat stress risk assessment (HSRA) or residency check requirements.

We will inform you if we require an [independent observer](#) to accompany your livestock voyage by sea.

Note that the approval of the NOI does not necessarily mean that we will issue the export permit and health certificate. These will only be issued once we are satisfied that the livestock have been prepared in accordance with the importing country's requirements and comply with Australian export legislation.

Note that we may revoke the approval of your NOI if you provide false, misleading, or incomplete information or documents to us.

If there are changes to your consignment you must update your NOI. To do this, you need to apply to vary an NOI in TRACE.

Access to TRACE is through the [Export Service](#). You will need to create an account to use the service.

Get set up in the Export Service

Follow our step-by-step guide [TRACE onboarding to the Export Service](#).

After your account is set up, you need to [connect TRACE to the Export Service](#).

The NOI should be as accurate as possible. You should make a variation as soon as you know the information is out of date.

We will contact you by email if we need more information.

You must carry out pre-export preparations in accordance with your [AA](#) and [AEP](#).

You must [contact us](#) if:

- importing country requirements change
- your operations are no longer reflected in your AA and/or AEP.

Email livestockexp@aff.gov.au.

In some circumstances, you may be able to source livestock for export where the property of origin is a registered establishment. These livestock are called 'stock on hand'.

More information is in our 'stock on hand' policy which applies to consignments that are exported on or after 1 August 2024.

Download

- ['Stock on hand' in registered establishments for livestock exports \(PDF 641 KB\)](#)
- ['Stock on hand' in registered establishments for livestock exports \(DOCX 1.87 MB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Pre-export preparation and inspection

An AAV must carry out the activities outlined in your AEP including inspecting your consignment. This must occur before our regional veterinary officer (RVO) inspects the consignment.

You must remove ineligible livestock from the consignment before the RVO inspection. ASEL has requirements for managing reject livestock.

Before you apply for an export permit and health certificate (EPHC) you must have all pre-export documentation as outlined in your AA and AEP.

We base export document requirements prior to export on the:

- exporter's performance level
- specific export market

We can also request you provide additional documentation if required.

Exporter performance level

We base the documents you must provide prior to export on your performance level. Information on performance levels can be found in the [performance management and compliance guidelines](#).

If you are a provisional exporter, you must provide all documentation prior to export.

Specific export market

Export documents include core and non-core documents.

Core documents are the minimum documents we require you to provide the RVO prior to export if you have an AA and AEP. The core documents list and importing country requirements are subject to change(s) at any time. You must check requirements for each market before you start the export process. We can also request you provide additional documentation (including non-core documents) if required.

If a market has no agreed importing country requirements in place, the core documents list is indicative only. You must contact our [regional office](#) to find out what documentation you must present.

The required documents should be uploaded to the relevant NOI on TRACE. The RVO can then consider issuing the export permit and health certificate (EPHC).

Download

- [Core documents for approved arrangement livestock exports \(PDF 196 KB\)](#)
- [Core documents for approved arrangement livestock exports \(DOCX 757 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Pre-export documentation requirements

This table provides some general information on what we require from you to demonstrate compliance with our requirements. This table is general information only, not specific to any market and not an exhaustive list. You must make sure you hold all documents as per your AA demonstrating compliance with our regulatory framework before export.

Document description	Key requirements
Import permit and certified translation from the competent authority (where relevant). This includes the import health conditions for the market (where relevant).	
Dispensation from the competent authority linked to a valid import permit (where relevant). This includes transit permits from any relevant transit countries and accredited translations (where relevant)	
National vendor declarations/waybills completed in accordance with state and territory requirements	

Download

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Property of origin (POO) clearances from the state or territory government

Download

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Vendor declarations completed correctly covering the importing country requirements and ASEL

Isolation declaration from the establishment or premises operator covering the importing country requirements and ASEL (where relevant)

Download

Laboratory test reports (including details and results)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Pregnancy declaration or spay certification (where relevant)

AAV health/welfare declaration

Test and treatment details and declarations from the relevant persons as per the AA/AEP

Reject list for livestock still in the RE (where relevant)

Disinfectant declarations from the land transport companies and/or the master of the vessel (where relevant)

Final tag list to be attached to the health certificate(s) for the consignment

Load plan and weights including the preliminary and final load plan, final number of head and final weights (at final sign off). This also includes crate dimensions for air consignments.

Water deprivation plan (air only)

The required documents should be uploaded to the relevant NOI on TRACE. The RVO will assess these when making a decision to issue the EPHC.

Exporters must ensure that all documents are complete and correct and are able to demonstrate compliance with our regulatory framework prior to submitting an application for the EPHC.

Where you identify issues with documentation collected from third parties that draws into question the eligibility of the livestock for export, you must seek to have these corrected prior to export. In some cases, you may be able to provide supporting information to the RVO to demonstrate compliance with our regulatory framework for the purposes of issuing an EPHC. For example, if the truck driver section of an NT Waybill has not been completed, you may be able to provide intake records from the registered establishment showing arrival information as supporting evidence.

You must ensure that all information and documentation you provide to us is true and accurate.

You need an export permit and health certificate (EPHC) for each export consignment.

Complete your [application form for an EPHC](#). Submit the form on TRACE.

Let us know if there are changes to your consignment. It may invalidate your issued export permit and health certificate.

For more information, contact your [local regional office](#).

Our RVOs inspect all livestock consignments before export. Arrange your inspection through our [regional office in your state or territory](#)

Inspections are usually done within 72 hours of departure. This may change due to importing country requirements.

The inspections take place at:

- registered establishments for livestock to be exported by sea
- approved premises for most livestock to be exported by air
- other premises for livestock if an approved premise is not required.

The inspection ensures that livestock for export meet the:

- [Australian Standards for the Export of Livestock \(ASEL\)](#)
- importing country requirements
- legislative requirements
- exporter's AA and AEP.

We may require the stopping of moving or loading livestock in the initial stages of a suspicion or detection of an exotic animal disease, infection or infestation in Australia.

We will issue your EPHC after you have met all our requirements.

Our description on the EPHC only identifies the species of livestock. We do not identify the breed as this is a commercial matter.

We will also issue your consignment a rating as per the [Performance Management and Compliance Guidelines](#). These ratings are known as livestock export consignment reports (LECR). They inform your exporter performance level.

We will note concerns or issues identified during the inspection and let you know in writing.

We charge a fee for the EPHC. See [our charging guidelines](#).

Circumstances may change after we issue the consignment documentation. We may need to revoke and reissue the EPHC. Please [contact us](#) to discuss as soon as possible if this may apply to your consignment.

Once you receive the EPHC you can export your consignment.

Notifiable incidents

We outline notifiable incidents for livestock export conveyances [in ASEL](#). Examples include, but are not limited to:

- mechanical issues impacting animal health or welfare
- feed or water shortage
- diagnosis or reasonable suspicion of an emergency disease in a consignment
- rejection of livestock by an importing country government.

If a notifiable incident occurs at any time, [contact us](#) as soon as possible and in any case, within 12 hours. While we are reviewing and responding to the incident, you are responsible for activating any contingency plans [prepared as per ASEL](#).

Notifiable incident reports

Some incidents require you to submit a report to us. See [ASEL for more information](#).

Email the report to livestockexp@aff.gov.au.

Returning to Australia

In some cases, livestock loaded onto a vessel or aircraft for export may need unloading back into Australia. Unloading of livestock from a conveyance must only occur with our approval.

To allow unloading, we need to assess the biosecurity risks of the situation. We will require information from you to undertake this process.

Among other things, we need to verify if the livestock could have been exposed to a disease or pest that may compromise Australia's highly favourable animal, plant, and human health status. This is consistent with the process for other goods returning to Australia. If biosecurity risks are identified, we may require you to take measures and/or comply with directions or other obligations under the Biosecurity Act 2015.

These measures may include, but are not limited to:

- identifying suitable quarantine facilities to transport the livestock to or from the vessel

- isolating unloaded livestock from other livestock, if present, in the quarantine facility
- daily veterinary inspections
- use of personal protective equipment
- cleaning of equipment, vehicles, and/or properties with certain products.

We will inform you if any measures change.

Master's report

The master of the livestock vessel must provide a copy of the 'master's report carriage of livestock' to us and the Australian Maritime Safety Authority (AMSA). They must provide it after the voyage.

Further information on the format and required recipients can be found on the [AMSA website](#).

Email the report to livestockexp@aff.gov.au.

ASEL reporting

Under [ASEL](#), you must provide us with regulatory reports for all livestock consignments.

Reports include:

- daily reports (where applicable) for livestock exported by sea
- end-of-voyage report for livestock exported by sea
- end-of-journey report for livestock exported by air.

LIVEXCollect

Use the [LIVEXCollect](#) forms for your reports. It is a LiveCorp-administered data collection and management system. It is the approved form by us for meeting your ASEL reporting requirements.

The use of LIVEXCollect supports:

- our regulatory functions
- LiveCorp activities such as the research and service body for the livestock export industry.

For more information on LIVEXCollect, visit the [LiveCorp website](#).

Register

Register for access to LIVEXCollect by emailing livexcollect@livecorp.com.au.

Submit

Complete and submit these forms within the timeframes in [ASEL](#).

Email completed forms to livestockexp@aff.gov.au and livexcollect@livecorp.com.au.

Support

Contact LIVEXCollect for any support or training to use the program.

Email livexcollect@livecorp.com.au.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/controlled-goods/live-animals/livestock/exporters/exporting-livestock-consignments>